Weekly Update Guide 2026-27 (after Upgrade 17)

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Each week is three commands and three short Excel steps after the games (about 15 minutes), plus one odds command on Friday before the next round (2 minutes). Use the label of the gameweek just played, e.g. "2026-27 after GW7".

Before you start

Do this when the last match of the gameweek has finished and every score is in. Mondays work well, before the next gameweek's team news.

- **Files:** these must all be in `C:\Users\<you>\OneDrive\Prem Project\DC upgrade (6)`: weekly.py, dc_model.py, benchmarks.py, market_model.py, dynamic_sims.py, fpl_availability.py, player_data.py, player_minutes.py, player_rates.py, team_counts.py, player_markets.py, match_markets.py and slip_checker.py.
- **Password:** open a new VS Code terminal there and run `python -c "import os; print('PREM_DB_URL' in os.environ)"`. It must print True. If it prints False, close VS Code completely and reopen it.
- **The run label:** `2026-27 after GW7` = the season, then `after GW`, then the last gameweek where every match has a result (postponed games aside). Type it once and copy it into every command. Never reuse a label already loaded (see F1 under Troubleshooting).
- **Files closed:** close the model and the dashboard before any command that reads them.

The weekly steps

The example uses GW7. Change the label and gameweek numbers each week.

1. **Excel: enter the scores (3 min).** Open `prem simulation 26-27 EXPORT.xlsx`, type the gameweek's scores on Results (leave postponed games blank), Ctrl+S, close.
2. **VS Code: part1 (2 min).** `python weekly.py part1 "2026-27 after GW7"`. Expect: 380 fixtures with 70 scores, Understat downloaded, xg.csv and odds.csv with 70 matches, no unknown team names, UPDATE matches 380, match_xg 70, availability 20, played = with_xg, and one row `7 | 20` for games per team. It also settles last week's logged prices with the closing odds and results ("value_log: 50 prices settled"); if it says 0, football-data hasn't added the closing odds yet, so rerun part1 later in the week.
3. **Excel: availability, xG, F9 (3 min).**

   a. Open the model and `exports\2026-27 after GW7\availability.csv` (in PowerShell: `start "C:\Users\<you>\OneDrive\Prem Project\exports\2026-27 after GW7\availability.csv"`).
   b. Copy A1:H21 and paste it into the Availability sheet with Ctrl+Alt+V, Values, so the formatting stays.
   c. Set NextGW to 8 on Settings.
   d. Right-click the xG table, Refresh. Press F9 and wait until it finishes calculating.
   e. Check Team Strength updated J:K has no blanks. Ctrl+S, close.
4. **VS Code: part2 (5 min).** `python weekly.py part2 "2026-27 after GW7"`. Expect: 0 seasons not summing to 210, ratings 20, sims 20000, then dc_model, benchmarks, market_model and dynamic_sims each "done", ens_mkt_50 380 (this step sits on "--- ensemble" for about 3 minutes, which is normal), 380 rows for each source, and the new top 6.
5. **VS Code: part3, first time (1 min).** `python weekly.py part3 "2026-27 after GW7"`. It writes referees_next.csv for GW8, lists the games and stops.
6. **Referees (3 min).** Run the `notepad` command part3 printed. Type each referee from premierleague.com "Match officials for Matchweek 8" into the referee column (full names are fine), save, close.
7. **VS Code: part3 again (5 min).** Same command. It loads the referees, writes each GW8 fixture's expected goals, updates the player data, runs the five next scripts, downloads the upcoming odds, logs this round's prices for the value tracker and prints the checks. Expect `All checks OK.`
8. **Dashboard (3 min).**
   a. Add `2026-27 after GW7` at the bottom of Lists column A.
   b. With the model closed, open `Prem_Dashboard.xlsx` and press Data, Refresh All. Wait for every query.
   c. Pick the new label in H2H C6.
   d. Look over Forecast, Player, H2H (a GW8 fixture, home team first, including Value vs bookmaker), Match markets, Referees, Hit rates (last 5 games vs the model) and Value tracker (last week's prices now settled), then Ctrl+S.
9. **Slips (optional).** Edit slip.csv in the DC upgrade (6) folder in Notepad (one row per leg, every leg of a slip in the same match), run `python slip_checker.py`, then Refresh All.
10. **Log.** Add a one-line row to the Upgrade log only if something changed or broke.

Friday (2 min): fresh odds for the value check. football-data.co.uk updates its upcoming-games odds on Fridays (weekend) and Tuesdays (midweek). Run `python weekly.py odds`, then Refresh All in the dashboard. H2H's "Value vs bookmaker" section fills home / draw / away and over / under 2.5 for any next-gameweek fixture (home team first), from

the source picked in its Odds source cell (Average, Bet365 or Best price). Type BTTS by hand: it isn't in the free file. A green VALUE flag means a possible edge to check, not a bet: the bookmakers have been more accurate than the model over 2024-26.

Value tracker (automatic). The same `odds` command logs every next-gameweek price (home, draw, away, over and under 2.5, Bet365) with the model's chance, the blended chance, the edge and the flag in `value_log`. Monday's part1 fills in the closing odds and the result from football-data's results file, so nothing is typed. The dashboard's Value tracker sheet (`v_value_summary` , `v_value_log`) shows whether VALUE prices beat the closing odds. That is the real test: above 50% beating the close with a positive average CLV, over 100+ flagged prices. Profit is too noisy to judge until much later.

What each step covers

The automation covers every upgrade with a weekly step, 1 to 15. Upgrade 16 (the password variable) is what lets the scripts connect, and Upgrade 18 (GitHub) is a one-off with nothing weekly.

Step	What it does	Upgrades
Excel: scores	The results everything else is built on	1-6
part1	Results, Understat xG and bookmaker odds into prem_sims; FPL availability snapshot; settles last week's value_log prices with closing odds and results; the played / xG / games checks	1-6 (weekly guide Stages A-D), 10 (odds), 14 (availability), 17 (value tracker)
Excel: availability, xG, F9	Recalculates the ratings (xG blend, home advantage, availability) and the 1,000 season sims	1-6, 13, 14
part2	Loads the run's ratings and sims; Dixon-Coles, pi-ratings and dc_xg, the market model, the uncertainty sims, the model + market ensemble	1-6 (Stages E-F), 7-12

Step	What it does	Upgrades
part3	GW+1 referees, each fixture's expected goals (15.5a), player and team data, minutes, rates, team counts, player markets, match markets; upcoming odds and the value log	15, 17
part3 / check: checks	Every table above checked for the run, OK or CHECK	1-15
odds (Friday)	Fresh upcoming odds for H2H's Value vs bookmaker, and re-logs this round's prices until kick-off	17
Dashboard Refresh All	Every sheet reads the new run, including Value tracker	1-17

`python weekly.py check "2026-27 after GW7"` reprints the checks at any time without changing anything.

The checks

Every line should say OK. A CHECK line names what is off; the fix is in the last column.

Check	OK means	If it says CHECK
part1: played vs with xG	Equal	Understat hasn't posted a game yet: rerun part1 later
part1: availability snapshot	20 teams	Run `python fpl_availability.py "<label>"`, then script 28 blocks 14.5b-14.5d
part2: ratings and sims	20 and 20,000	Run not loaded properly: F1, then part2 again
part2: dixon_coles, market, ens_mkt_50, pi_ratings, dc_xg	380 each	Rerun that script by hand (weekly guide Stage F)
15.5a expected goals	One per next-gameweek fixture	Rerun part3

Check	OK means	If it says CHECK
referees: have one / have history	Every fixture / every referee	Blank = not filled in, or spelled differently from football-data (e.g. `M Oliver`): fix referees_next.csv, rerun part3
player_minutes: starters	11 per team	Rerun part3; if it stays off, send the output
player_minutes: above FPL chance	0 players	You're on an old player_minutes.py: replace it
team_counts / match_markets	21 / 100 rows per fixture	Rerun part3
player_markets	Every fixture	Rerun part3
v_fixture_card / v_player_card	2 teams per fixture / 300+ players	Script 30 blocks 15.10f and 15.10g not run yet
info: upcoming odds	Every next-gameweek game has odds	Only an info line: fixtures.csv updates on Fridays and Tuesdays, so run python weekly.py odds then

Troubleshooting

Message	Fix
`Model not found`	Fix MODEL_PATH at the top of weekly.py (the file is `prem simulation 26-27 EXPORT.xlsx`)
`Understat download failed` and no json	Save it by hand (old weekly guide Stage B) as `understat_2026-27.json` in the run's exports folder, rerun part1
`Unknown team names` listed	Add the alias in pgAdmin, e.g. `INSERT INTO team_aliases (alias, team_id) SELECT 'Hull', team_id FROM teams WHERE team_name = 'Hull City';`, rerun part1
`Team Strength updated A/J/K has blanks` or `Simulations look wrong`	Open the model, refresh xG, F9, wait, Ctrl+S, close, rerun part2

Message	Fix
`is already loaded`	F1 below, then part2 again
`is not loaded yet` (part3)	Run part1 and part2 first
part3 stops at referees	Fill in referees_next.csv and run part3 again; if appointments aren't out, add `--skip-referees` and rerun part3 once they are
A script stops part3 with an error	Send the error; after the fix, rerun part3 (it replaces its own rows)
Excel: password authentication failed	Data, Get Data, Data Source Settings: update the ODBC credentials (Database, user postgres)
Excel: can't move cells in a filtered range	Right-click that table, Table, External Data Properties: Overwrite existing cells, clear unused cells
`PermissionError` on a csv or xlsx	Close it in Excel and rerun
No Premier League games in fixtures.csv yet	football-data hasn't posted the next round's odds: run python weekly.py odds again on Friday (weekend games) or Tuesday (midweek)
value_log: 0 prices settled, or nothing waiting to settle	Closing odds aren't in the results file yet (they arrive a day or two after the games): rerun part1 later in the week; it's safe to rerun
H2H Value vs bookmaker shows no odds	Pick a next-gameweek fixture with the home team first, run python weekly.py odds, then Refresh All; type BTTS by hand

F1. Replace a run already loaded (wrong score, label reused). In pgAdmin, change the label in every line, run them in order, then run part2 and part3 again:

```
DELETE FROM external_predictions WHERE run_label = '2026-27 after GW7';
DELETE FROM match_lambdas WHERE run_label = '2026-27 after GW7';
DELETE FROM sim_results  WHERE run_id = (SELECT run_id FROM model_runs WHERE
run_label = '2026-27 after GW7');
DELETE FROM team_ratings WHERE run_id = (SELECT run_id FROM model_runs WHERE
run_label = '2026-27 after GW7');
DELETE FROM model_runs   WHERE run_label = '2026-27 after GW7';
```

Expect about 1,900 (five sources x 380), 10, 20,000, 20 and 1. The bookmaker odds use the label `odds`, so they are kept. If a score was wrong, fix it on Results and rerun part1 first.